

Lab 1: 3-Card Portfolio Showcase (Inline-Block Layout)

Weight: 3.75% | Released: Week 2 (Studio Hour 3) | Due: One day prior to Week 3 class by 11:59 PM EDT

1. Overview & What to Create

In this lab, you will expand on the techniques practiced in the walk-along by building a 3-Card Portfolio Showcase page from scratch. Your layout must feature a full-width header, an introductory profile bio section, a project container holding 3 distinct project/skill cards (<article> tags), and a full-width footer. You must build this layout strictly using inline-block multi-column styling and media queries (Flexbox and Grid are not allowed for this lab).

2. Target Layout Wireframe

```
+-----+
|                                     |
|               <header>              | <-- Full Width Header
|               <h1> Student Showcase </h1> | Padding: 20px
|                                     |
+-----+

+-----+
| <main>                               | <-- Full Width Intro Bio
|   <section class="intro">             |
|     <h2> Developer Profile </h2>     |
|     <p> Short personal bio and introduction statement... </p> |
|   </section>                         |
|                                     |
|   <section class="cards-container">  |
|     +-----+ +-----+ +-----+ | <-- Desktop (>=768px):
|     | <article> | | <article> | | <article> | display: inline-block
|     | Project 1 | | Project 2 | | Project 3 | width: 30%
|     | width: 30% | | width: 30% | | width: 30% | margin-right: 3%
|     +-----+ +-----+ +-----+ | vertical-align: top
|   </section>                         | <-- Mobile (<768px):
| </main>                               | cards stack (width: 100%)
|                                     |
+-----+

+-----+
|               <footer>              | <-- Full Width Footer
|               <p> © 2026 Student Showcase </p> | Margin-Top: 24px
|               |
+-----+
```

3. Repository Setup & VS Code Workflow

Step A: Setup Repository from Course Template

- Go to the course template repository: <https://github.com/gayangmg/CCT360-template>
- Click the green Use this template button (or create a new repository) and name your repository lab1.
- Ensure repository visibility is set to Public.
- Copy your new repository's HTTPS URL (e.g., <https://github.com/your-username/lab1.git>).

Step B: Clone Repository into CCT360/labs/lab1 via VS Code

- Open VS Code.
- Press Ctrl+Shift+P (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+P (Mac) to open the Command Palette.
- Type Git: Clone, press Enter, and paste your copied repository HTTPS URL.
- Select your local workspace folder (e.g., CCT360/labs/) so VS Code clones it directly into CCT360/labs/lab1.
- Click Open when prompted to load the project workspace.

Step C: Commit & Push Updates using VS Code Source Control

- After editing index.html and css/style.css, click the Source Control icon (Git icon) on the left sidebar (or press Ctrl+Shift+G / Cmd+Shift+G).
- Enter a descriptive commit message in the message box (e.g., 'Completed Lab 1 layout').
- Click Commit (or the checkmark icon).
- Click Sync Changes / Push to upload your code directly to GitHub.

4. Technical CSS & HTML Requirements

- Directory Structure: Must feature index.html at root, a css/ folder, and css/style.css linked inside <head>.
- HTML Structure: Include viewport meta tag (<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">). Use semantic tags (<header>, <main>, <section>, <article>, <footer>). Place 3 distinct <article> elements inside the cards section.
- Universal Reset: Clear default browser spacing using * { margin: 0; padding: 0; box-sizing: border-box; } at the top of css/style.css.
- Mobile-First Base Styles (<768px): Project cards stack vertically at width: 100% with margin-bottom: 16px.
- Desktop Responsive Breakpoint (>=768px): Add @media (min-width: 768px) { ... }. Style cards as display: inline-block; width: 30%; margin-right: 3%; vertical-align: top; so all 3 cards align side-by-side in a single row without wrapping.

5. Deployment & Quercus Submission

- Enable GitHub Pages under Settings -> Pages (Branch: main, Folder: /root).
- Submit two URLs on Quercus: (1) GitHub Repository URL (e.g., <https://github.com/username/lab1>) and (2) Live GitHub Pages URL (e.g., <https://username.github.io/lab1/>).

6. Submission Checklist

- ☐ Created repository from template (<https://github.com/gayangmg/CCT360-template>) and cloned via VS Code into CCT360/labs/lab1.
- ☐ Universal reset applied (* { margin: 0; padding: 0; box-sizing: border-box; }).
- ☐ Linked stylesheet correctly inside css/style.css.
- ☐ Created 3 distinct <article> elements for project/skill cards.
- ☐ Mobile view (<768px): All 3 cards stack vertically at 100% width.
- ☐ Desktop view (>=768px): Cards display side-by-side using display: inline-block; width: 30%; margin-right: 3%; vertical-align: top;.
- ☐ Pushed updates using VS Code Source Control icon and verified live GitHub Pages link.